ners in these categories are ISB, Hyderabad (best one-year management course) and IIM, Ahmedabad (best executive management programme). While the traditional ranking of two-year management courses is based purely on objective data collected from the B-schools, these three rankings are based on a combination of secondary data plus a perception survey of different stakeholders.

The survey also exposes the abysmally low share of female students in business schools, particularly among the top 25—34 per cent—though it is an improvement from the 28 per cent in 2015. Ironically, the lower ranked B-schools show better gender ratios, with women accounting for 47 per cent of the total students in institutes ranked between 76 and 100. According to the AMBA Application and Enrolment Report 2022, only 19 per cent of the aspirants and 20 per cent of the students enrolled in management education were women in contrast to China where the figures are 49 per cent and 50 per cent, respectively. This is unfortunate as women are considered to have natural strengths in terms of personality traits essential for leadership positions. A 2021 survey conducted by the Pew Research Center found that women tend to exhibit greater honesty, empathy and innovation as leaders.

The B-schools of the country must now take pro-active steps to encourage and facilitate admission of more female students in management courses. It will certainly add more muscle to the already growing women workforce. In 2023, women in mid-market companies in India held 36 per cent of senior management positions, surpassing the global average of 32 per cent, reveals the Women in Business Report 2023 by the advisory firm Grant Thornton. What's even more encouraging is that the percentage of Indian businesses with a female CEO/MD has almost doubled from 29 in 2019 to 53 now. At least one woman founder or co-founder

SHARE OF FEMALE STUDENTS IN B-SCHOOLS

RANK OF B-SCHOOLS	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023
TOP 1 - 25	27.8%	26.3%	28.6%	28.6%	30.3%	30.3%	32.3%	34.5%	33.6%
TOP 26 - 50	40%	37%	40%	37%	43.5%	37%	37%	33.3%	34.2%
TOP 51 - 75	37%	41.7%	41.7%	40%	41.7%	43.5%	41.7%	43.5%	44.8%
TOP 76 - 100	35.7%	38.5%	43.5%	41.7%	41.7%	47.6%	45.5%	45.5%	47.4%

THE COST OF BUSINESS SKILLS

Average fee for the entire course charged by B-schools

RANK OF B-SCHOOLS	AVERAGE COURSE FEES (TUITION FEE+ OTHER FEES)
TOP 1-25	₹17,70,344
TOP 26-50	₹11,14,883
TOP 51-75	₹9,61,211
TOP 76-100	₹7,41,574

GOVERNMENT VS PRIVATE

(Among top-100 B-schools)

CATEGORY OF B-SCHOOLS	AVERAGE COURSE FEES (TUITION FEE+ OTHER FEES)
GOVERNMENT	₹10,84,239
PRIVATE	₹11,72,639

THE BEST VALUE FOR MONEY SCHOOLS

How different categories of B-schools fare in terms of return on money spent as course fee

RANK OF B-SCHOOLS	AVERAGE RoI*
TOP 1 - 25	1.27
TOP 26 - 50	1.03
TOP 51 - 75	0.86
TOP 76 - 100	0.92

GOVERNMENT VS PRIVATE

Among top-100 B-schools

CATEGORY OF B-SCHOOLS	AVERAGE RoI
GOVERNMENT	1.60
PRIVATE	0.87

**Note: RoI (return on investment) is calculated by dividing average domestic annual salary with fees for the entire course*